Mana Steps

Matthew, this is what the app is: Mana Steps is a phone app I'm building to teach complete beginners how to play Magic: The Gathering, one small step at a time.

You read short lessons, answer easy check questions, then practise real moves (playing a land, casting a creature, attacking, blocking and responding to a spell) on a practice table that gives hints and lets you undo. No timers, no losing, no streaks.

It's built for brains like mine: ADHD, autism and dyslexia. It has dark mode, readable fonts and plain language, and nothing pops up or surprises you.

The next step is picking a ready-made deck and playing a full practice game against the computer, with a coach that tells you the best move and why.

To keep it true to the real game, every lesson step points to the official Magic Comprehensive Rules (the rulebook Wizards of the Coast publishes) and lists the rule number. The colour and card design lessons follow published design articles by Mark Rosewater, Magic's head designer. The practice engine enforces the real turn order, mana, combat and stack rules, with automated tests. The practice cards are real cards from the Foundations set, with their official art and exact rules text, used under the Wizards Fan Content Policy. It clearly says it's an unofficial fan-made tool, and it's free.

- Power and toughness in the bottom-right corner (creatures only)

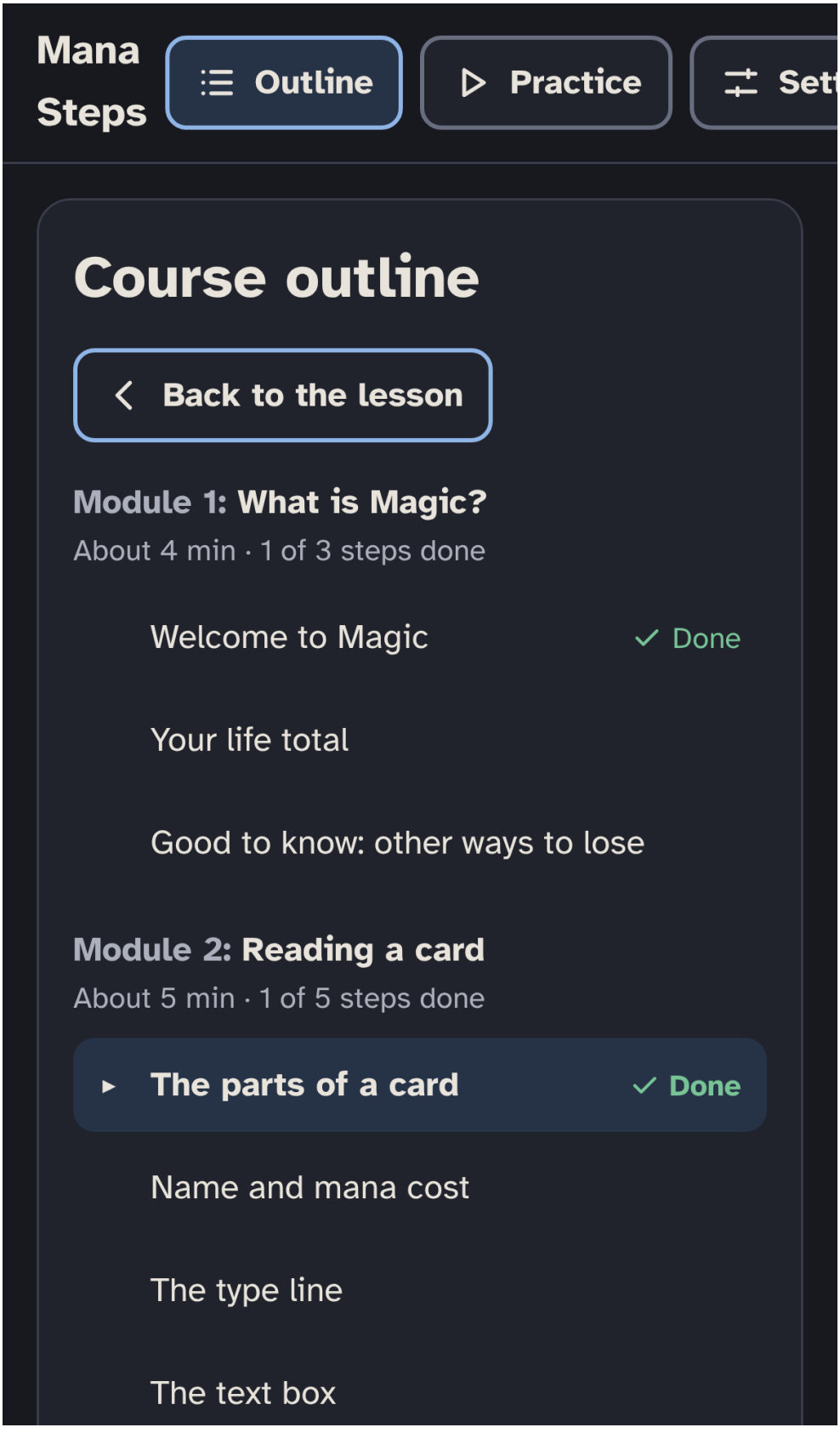


Brazen Scourge: name at the top, mana cost on the picture, type line, text box, and power and toughness in the corner. Art by Kev Walker. © Wizards of the Coast.

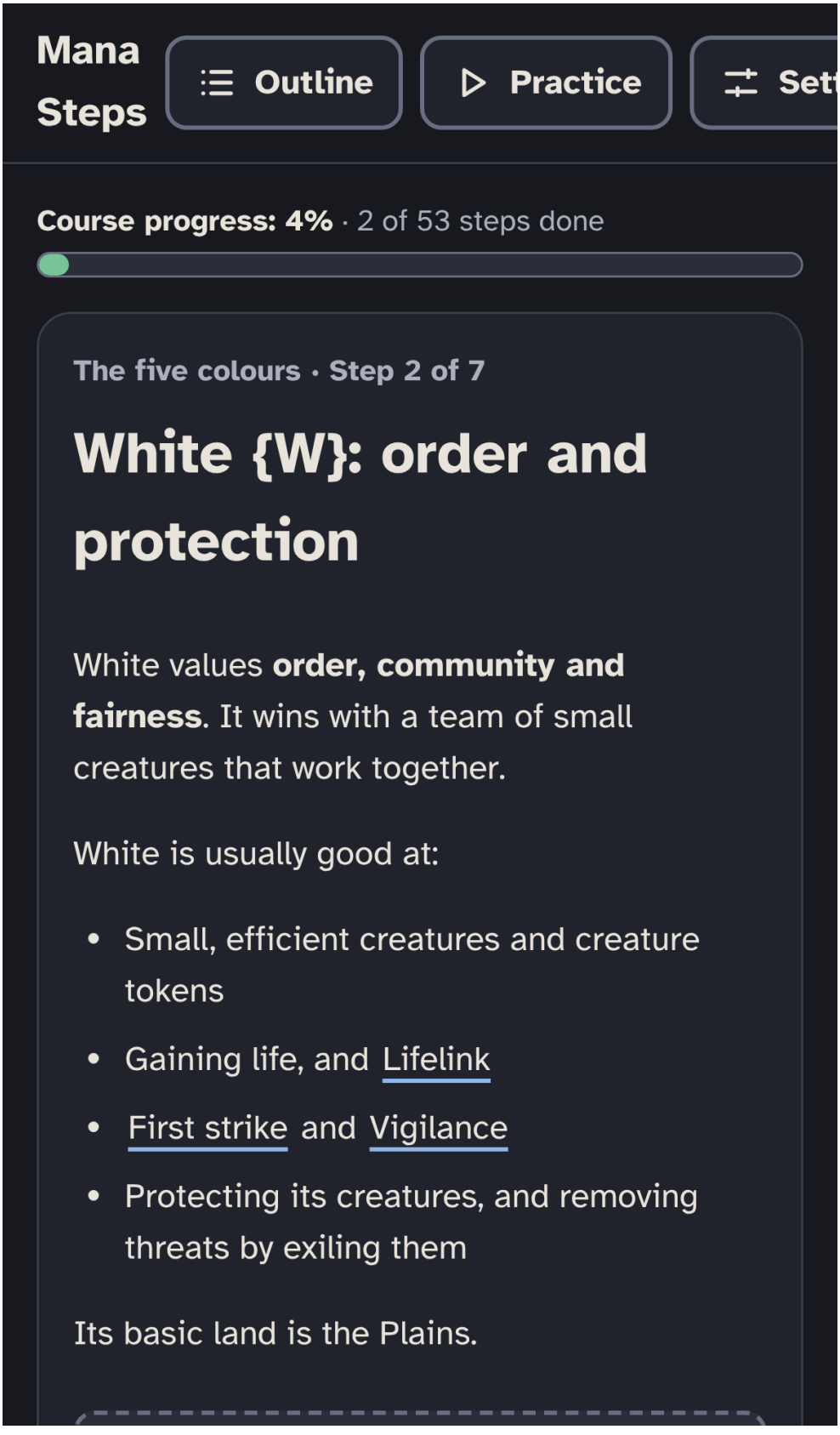
Rule reference: CR 109.3 (Magic Comprehensive Rules)

Module checklist · 0 of 4 ticked

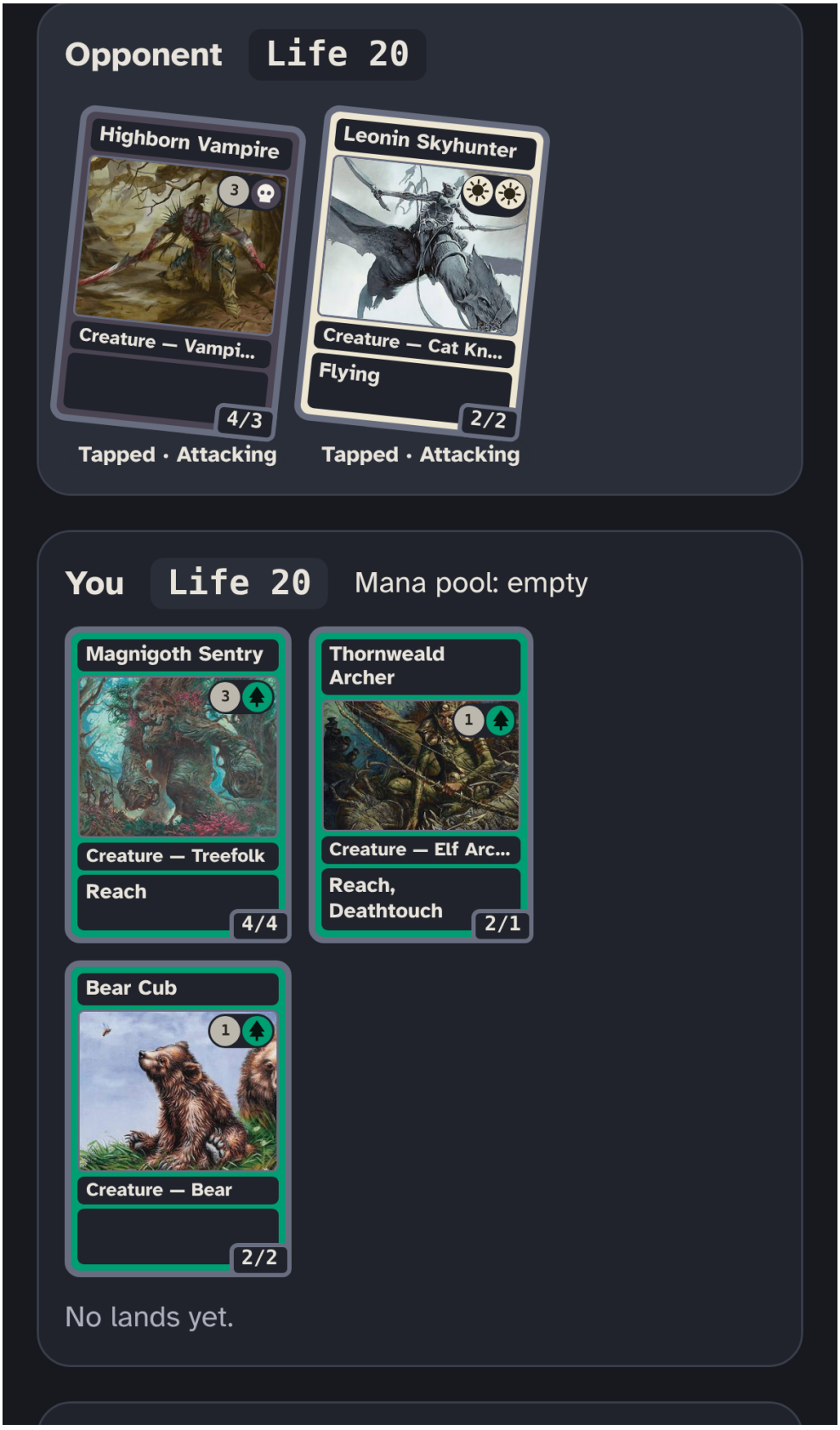
A lesson: the parts of a card, shown on a real Foundations card (Brazen Scourge).



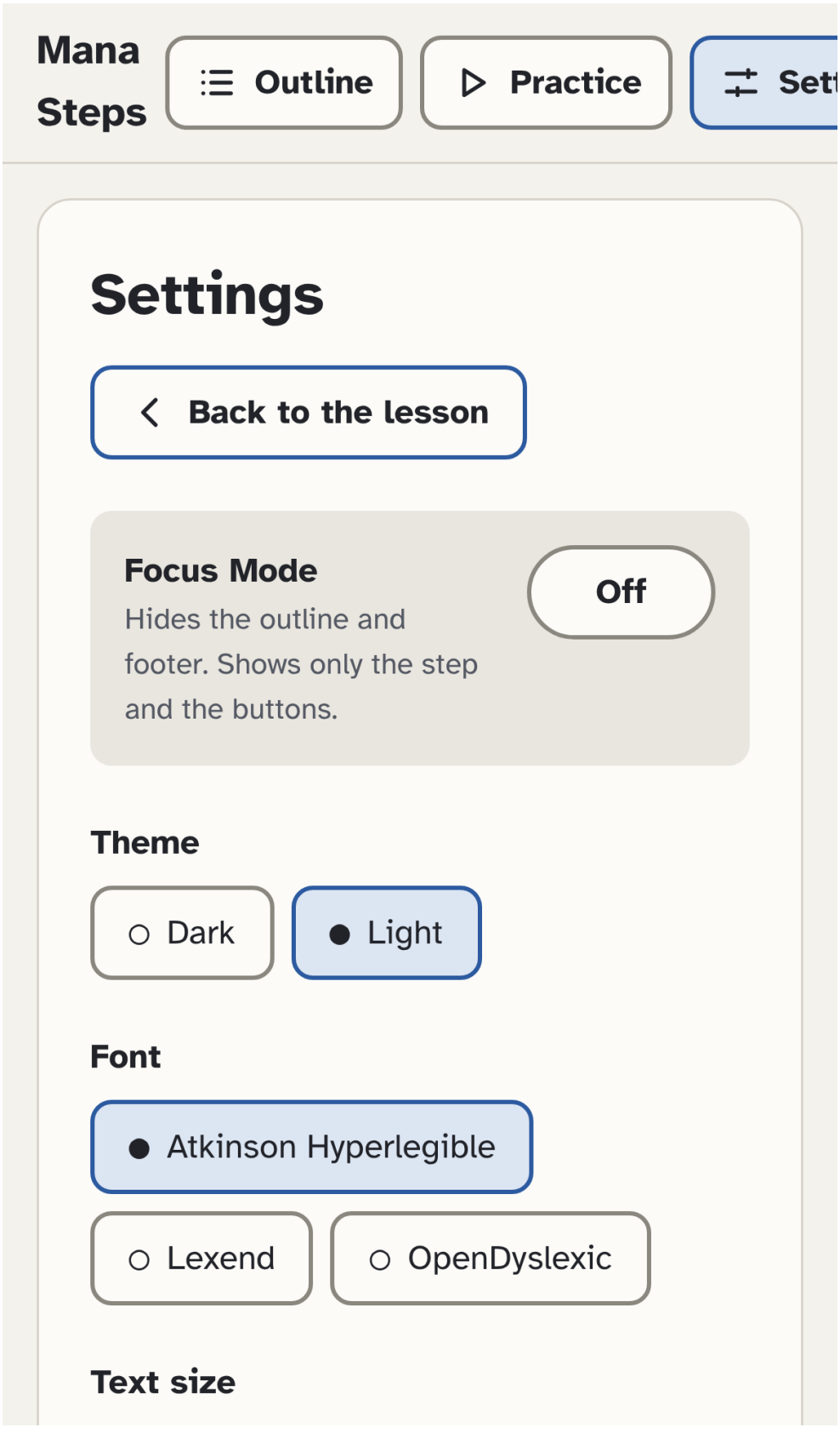
The course outline: 11 modules, 53 steps, with Done marks and progress per module.



The colour pie lesson: what each colour is good at, with tappable glossary words.



The practice table: the opponent attacks, and you choose blocks. Hints and Undo are always there.



Settings in light mode: Focus Mode, theme, and three readable fonts including OpenDyslexic.

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